SAMRAT GETS GOING

A MONTH AND A HALF INTO OFFICE, BIHAR CHIEF MINISTER SAMRAT CHOUDHARY IS DRIVING A GOVERNANCE MODEL CENTRED ON SPEED, VISIBILITY, ADMINISTRATIVE CONTROL AND AGGRESSIVE POLITICAL MESSAGING

By **AMITABH SRIVASTAVA**



WALKING THE TALK Samrat Choudhary en route to the state secretariat in Patna, following PM Narendra Modi's appeal to reduce fuel consumption, May 15

ANI

It is the weekend, yet Bihar chief minister Samrat Choudhary's residential office at 1, Anne Marg in Patna is unusually abuzz with activity. An additional chief secretary, a couple of MLAs and the administrative head of a management institute wait patiently for their turn to meet the man who is close to completing two months in office.

At the other end of the corridor, seated behind a desk strewn with files, loose papers and handwritten notes, Choudhary exudes visible command—a reflection of the distinct shift now underway in Bihar's governance style. If his predecessor Nitish Kumar's administrative culture was often defined by long, painstaking reviews, detailed file readings and interruptions such as 'go back to the previous presentation slide and explain', Choudhary's approach appears outcome-driven: 'Show me the result'.

The underlying political signal is unmistakable: the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) wants Bihar, under its leadership, to project visible momentum, speed and authority.

Last month, in a packed review session attended by district magistrates and superintendents of police, the CM spoke in clipped, impatient bursts for nearly 25 minutes. Criminals, Choudhary declared, must face relentless pursuit. Those who assault young girls, he told the senior officers, should be dealt with firmly. "*Mala pehna dijiye*" (garland their photographs), he said, which is understood as a signal to neutralise hardened criminals. "He does not speak in the old bureaucratic idiom of 'the law will take its own course', as his predecessor often did," says one senior official. "The Samrat doctrine appears direct: if criminals